

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

This article appeared in the student newspaper:

Hong Kong needs more blood donors

Hong Kong needs more people to give blood; and finding new blood donors is a central aim of the Hong Kong Red Cross.

The Hong Kong Red Cross supplies blood to all Hong Kong hospitals and these supplies of blood are vital for the effectiveness of Hong Kong's health services.

The Red Cross is always looking for new donors, but finding enough people to give blood is difficult.

Fortunately, schools and young people are willing to give blood, with over 70% of new blood donors coming from secondary school students. Currently, students over the age of 16 can give blood, with their parents' permission.

Chan Kin-hei, a representative of the Red Cross, said, "We are happy to go to schools at any time, but the schools should make sure that students have enough time to give blood, encourage them to take part by advertising our visit, and arrange for helpers to support our staff."

Chan stated that an important benefit of encouraging students to give blood is that once they give blood, many will continue to do so into their adult life. So not only is it important for the present needs of hospitals, but it is also good for long-term blood supplies.

He added that there were also health benefits for those who give blood: "It's good for the heart, reduces the risk of cancer, and also students get a free blood test to check if they have any health problems."

Your school would like to invite the Red Cross to collect blood from students and staff. You are a member of the Students' Union and the principal has asked you to help organise the event. You may want to talk about:

- why giving blood is important
- how to encourage students to take part in the event
- suitable times and places for the event
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Would you give blood?
2. Why do some people like to give blood?
3. How could more adults be encouraged to give blood?
4. Why are some people afraid of giving blood?
5. How can the Red Cross help donors to relax when giving blood?
6. What do students learn from giving blood?
7. Should people be paid to give blood?
8. Should giving blood be made compulsory?